

Word family: **front / fronts / fronted / fronting / frontal / forefront / frontage**

Base word: front

Plural: fronts

Past tense: fronted

Past participle: fronted

-ing form: fronting

Related forms: frontal, forefront, frontage

Useful constructions/extensions: in front of, at the front, front door, front page, front row, front line, front desk, front office, front of house, front for, front an organization/band/programme, face/front onto, forefront, frontage

Part of speech: noun (名詞) / adjective (形容詞) / verb (動詞)

Your passage contains:

> “I had to speak **in front of** about two hundred colleagues and several senior managers.”

Here, **front** is part of the fixed spatial expression:

> **in front of + person/thing**

meaning:

in a position facing and before someone or something.

Meaning in this passage

In:

> “speak **in front of** about two hundred colleagues...”

in front of means:

positioned before the audience, facing them, where they can see and hear you.

Meaning: In a position before and facing a person, group, or object.

繁體中文: 在某人／某群人前面，面向對方並處於他們能看見的位置

中文翻譯:

> “I had to speak in front of about two hundred colleagues and several senior managers.”

「我當時要**站在大約二百位同事和幾位高層經理面前發言**。」

So:

in front of an audience = 在觀眾面前／面向觀眾

This is the exact sense in your passage.

1. **in front of + person/thing (在.....前面) — 在.....前面; 面向.....**

This is the exact construction used in your passage.

Meaning: Positioned before another person, group, or object, usually facing them or being closer to the forward side.

Practice 1 — Original

> “I had to speak **in front of** about two hundred colleagues.”

「我要**在大約二百位同事面前**發言。」

Practice 2

> “She stood **in front of** the audience and began her presentation.”

「她站在**觀眾面前**開始簡報。」

Practice 3

> “A car stopped **in front of** the building.”

「一輛車停在大樓**前面**。」

in front of = 在某人／某物前方的位置

Context determines whether the Chinese is:

* 面前

* 前面

* 前方

2. **the front** = forward part of something (前部) — 前面; 前部

A major core meaning.

Meaning: The part of something that faces forward or is considered the main outward-facing side.

Practice 4

> “The logo is printed on the **front** of the folder.”

「標誌印在文件夾的**正面／前面**。」

Practice 5

> “There is a small garden at the **front** of the house.”

「房子的**前面**有一個小花園。」

the front = 某物朝向前方或主要外側的一面／部分

3. **front + noun** (前面的／前方的) — 前部的; 前面的

Here **front** functions adjectivally.

Practice 6

> “Please use the **front door**.”

「請使用**前門／正門**。」

Practice 7

> “We sat in the **front row**.”

「我們坐在**前排**。」

Common:

* front door = 前門／正門

* front seat = 前座

* front row = 前排

* front wheel = 前輪

* front pocket = 前袋

****front + noun = 位於前方、朝向前面的****

4. ****at the front(在最前面) — 在前面;在前方位置****

Practice 8

> “The senior managers were sitting ****at the front****.”

「高層經理坐在****最前面****。」

Practice 9

> “Please leave your name badge at the desk ****at the front****.”

「請把名牌放在****前面的櫃檯****。」

****at the front = 處於某個空間、隊伍或群體最前方的位置****

5. ****front of the room/class(房間／課室前方) — 前方;講台一帶****

A common educational/workplace spatial use.

Practice 10

> “She walked to the ****front of the room****.”

「她走到房間的****前方／講台位置****。」

Practice 11

> “The screen is at the ****front of the classroom****.”

「螢幕在課室的****前面****。」

****front of a room = 房間中通常面向觀眾、學生或主要活動區域的前方位置****

6. **front** = main visible side (正面) — 正面; 外表

This overlaps with physical front but often emphasizes the side that is shown to others.

Practice 12

> “The **front** of the building was covered in glass.”

「大樓的**正面**鋪滿玻璃。」

Practice 13

> “There is a large sign on the **front** of the shop.”

「店鋪**正面**有一個大招牌。」

front = 面向外界、最容易被看見的主要外側表面

7. **front page** (頭版) — 報紙頭版; 首頁

A highly useful compound.

Practice 14

> “The story appeared on the **front page**.”

「這則新聞登上了報紙**頭版**。」

Practice 15

> “The scandal dominated the **front page**.”

「這宗醜聞佔據了報紙**頭版**。」

front page = 報紙最前面、最重要的版面

In digital contexts, **front page** can also refer more broadly to a website's main page, though **homepage** is more common.

8. **front desk(接待處) — 前台;接待櫃檯**

A common hotel/office compound.

Practice 16

> “Please leave the key at the **front desk**.”

「請把鎖匙交到**前台／接待處**。」

Practice 17

> “Ask the **front desk** if you need help.”

「如果需要幫助，請向**接待處**查詢。」

front desk = 酒店、辦公室或機構入口附近負責接待訪客的櫃檯／部門

9. **front office(前台部門／管理部門) — 前台;管理層**

This has two useful senses depending on context.

A. Customer-facing reception/admin

> “The **front office** handles visitor enquiries.”

「**前台部門**負責處理訪客查詢。」

B. Sports/business management

> “The team’s **front office** made several major decisions.”

「球隊的**管理層**作出了幾項重大決定。」

front office = 負責對外接觸、接待，或在某些行業中指管理決策部門

10. **front of house(前台／觀眾區服務) — 前台服務區;對客服務部分**

Common in hospitality and theatre.

Practice 18

> “She works **front of house** at the theatre.”

「她在劇院負責**前台／觀眾接待工作**。」

Practice 19

> “The restaurant needs more **front-of-house staff**.”

「餐廳需要更多**前台／對客服務員工**。」

front of house = 與顧客、觀眾直接接觸的服務區域／工作

Contrast:

> **back of house**

= 後勤區／非直接對客服務部分

11. **front line** (前線) — 前線; 第一線

A major literal and figurative compound.

Practice 20

> “Soldiers were sent to the **front line**.”

「士兵被派往**前線**。」

Practice 21

> “Nurses were on the **front line** during the crisis.”

「危機期間，護士處於**第一線**。」

front line = 最接近戰鬥、危機或直接問題的位置

The figurative sense extends beyond war.

12. **front-line + worker/service** (第一線的) — 前線的; 第一線的

Practice 22

> “**Front-line workers** deal directly with customers.”

「**第一線員工**直接面對顧客。」

Practice 23

> “The policy affects **front-line staff** most.”

「這項政策對**前線員工**影響最大。」

front-line = 直接面對顧客、病人、危機或主要工作現場的

13. **front** = leading position (領先位置) — 前列; 領先地位

A figurative extension of spatial “front.”

Practice 24

> “The company is at the **front** of technological change.”

「這家公司處於科技變革的**前列**。」

Practice 25

> “She remained at the **front** of the movement.”

「她一直處於這場運動的**前列／領導位置**。」

front = 在某個領域、行動或發展中處於最前面／領先位置

More commonly expressed through:

> **at the forefront**

which is treated below.

14. ****forefront = leading position (最前沿) — 最前沿; 領先地位****

An important related form.

Practice 26

> “The company is at the ****forefront of**** artificial intelligence research.”

「這家公司處於人工智能研究的****最前沿****。」

Practice 27

> “She has been at the ****forefront of**** workplace reform.”

「她一直處於職場改革的****最前線／領先位置****。」

****at the forefront of = 在某個領域的發展、創新或行動中處於最領先的位置****

15. ****front = public image / outward appearance (表面形象) — 表面; 對外形象****

A strong figurative meaning.

****Meaning:**** The appearance or image shown to other people, which may hide the true situation.

Practice 28

> “He tried to maintain a calm ****front**** despite feeling nervous.”

「儘管很緊張, 他仍努力維持****冷靜的表面／外在形象****。」

Practice 29

> “The company put on a confident ****front**** during the crisis.”

「公司在危機期間表現出一副****自信的外在姿態****。」

****front = 特意展示給別人看的外在態度／形象, 可能跟真正感受不同****

16. ****put on a brave/confident front (裝出勇敢／自信) — 表面裝作.....****

Practice 30

> “I was nervous, but I tried to **put on a confident front**.”

「我雖然緊張，但仍努力**表現得很有自信**。」

Practice 31

> “She **put on a brave front** despite the bad news.”

「雖然收到壞消息，她仍**裝作堅強／表面保持勇敢**。」

put on a brave/confident front = 雖然內心可能不是如此，但對外表現出勇敢／自信

This is especially relevant to emotional contexts.

17. **front** = cover for hidden/illegal activity (掩護機構／幌子) — 幌子；掩護

A genuinely distinct figurative sense.

Practice 32

> “The business was allegedly a **front** for illegal activity.”

「據稱那家公司只是非法活動的**幌子／掩護**。」

Practice 33

> “The shop was used as a **front** for the operation.”

「那間店被用作該行動的**掩護場所**。」

a front for something = 表面上合法／正常，但實際用來掩飾另一項秘密或非法活動的組織／業務

18. **front** = area of conflict/activity (戰線／方面) — 戰線；方面

A broader abstract use.

Practice 34

> “The country was fighting on two **fronts**.”

「該國同時在兩條**戰線**作戰。」

Practice 35

> “The company is facing pressure on several **fronts**.”

「公司在幾個**方面／戰線**都面對壓力。」

on several fronts = 在幾個不同方面／領域同時面對行動、問題或競爭

This figurative plural use is very common.

19. **battle front / war front**(戰線) — 戰線; 前線地區

Practice 36

> “News arrived from the western **front**.”

「消息從西部**戰線**傳來。」

Practice 37

> “Thousands of soldiers were moved to the **front**.”

「數千名士兵被調往**前線**。」

front = 戰爭中軍隊直接交戰的地區／戰線

This is the historical military sense behind many figurative extensions.

20. **weather front**(氣象鋒面) — 鋒面

A major scientific meaning.

Meaning: A boundary between two masses of air with different temperatures or properties.

Practice 38

> “A cold **front** is moving across the region.”

「一道冷**鋒**正橫過該地區。」

Practice 39

> “The warm **front** brought heavy rain.”

「暖**鋒**帶來了大雨。」

weather front = 不同性質氣團之間的交界面／鋒面

Common:

* cold front = 冷鋒

* warm front = 暖鋒

* weather front = 天氣鋒面

21. **front** = organized political/social movement grouping (陣線／聯盟) — 陣線; 聯盟

A common organizational/political meaning.

Practice 40

> “Several groups formed a united **front**.”

「幾個團體組成了**統一陣線**。」

Practice 41

> “They presented a united **front** during the negotiations.”

「他們在談判中展現出**一致立場／統一陣線**。」

front = 為共同目標聯合行動的一群組織／人物, 或共同展現的立場

The fixed expression **united front** is particularly common.

22. **united front** (統一陣線／一致姿態) — 一致立場; 團結形象

This can be literal organizational language or figurative.

Practice 42

> “The managers showed a **united front** to employees.”

「管理層向員工展現了**一致立場**。」

Practice 43

> “Despite private disagreements, they maintained a **united front**.”

「儘管私下意見不合，他們仍維持**對外一致的姿態**。」

united front = 多方對外表現出一致、團結的立場，即使內部可能有分歧

23. **front** = façade / false outward appearance (表面假象) — 假象; 偽裝

Closely related to public-image **front**, but stronger when concealment is involved.

Practice 44

> “His confidence was only a **front**.”

「他的自信其實只是**表面假象／偽裝**。」

Practice 45

> “The friendly manner was a **front** hiding his frustration.”

「友善的態度只是掩飾他不滿的**表面偽裝**。」

front = 用來掩飾真實情緒、目的或情況的表面形象

24. **front** = face/address a particular direction (面向) — 面向; 朝向

Now **front** is a verb.

Practice 46

> “The hotel ****fronts the beach****.”

「酒店****面向海灘****。」

Practice 47

> “The building ****fronts onto**** a busy street.”

「大樓****正面朝向****一條繁忙街道。」

****front + place / front onto = 建築物或地方的正面朝向某個方向／地點****

25. ****front an organization/company (領導／代表) — 領導; 作為代表人物****

A figurative verb sense.

Practice 48

> “She ****fronts**** the organization’s public campaign.”

「她****領導／代表****該機構的公開宣傳活動。」

Practice 49

> “He was chosen to ****front**** the new initiative.”

「他獲選為新計劃的****主要代表人物／領導者****。」

****front an organization/campaign = 作為最公開、最主要的代表人物領導或代表某項活動****

26. ****front a band (擔任主唱／領隊) — 擔任樂隊主唱／核心人物****

A common music-industry use.

Practice 50

> “She ****fronts**** a successful rock band.”

「她是某成功搖滾樂隊的****主唱／核心人物****。」

Practice 51

> “The band is **fronted by** a well-known singer.”

「這支樂隊由一位知名歌手**擔任主唱／領軍**。」

front a band = 作為樂隊最主要、最具代表性的表演者，通常是主唱

27. **front a TV/radio programme(主持節目) — 主持**

A media use, especially British English.

Practice 52

> “She **fronts** a weekly current-affairs programme.”

「她**主持**一個每週時事節目。」

Practice 53

> “The documentary is **fronted by** a famous journalist.”

「這套紀錄片由一位著名記者**主持／擔任主要出鏡人物**。」

front a programme = 作為節目的主要主持／代表人物出現

28. **front for + activity/organization(作掩護) — 作為……的幌子**

Verb use corresponding to the noun sense.

Practice 54

> “The company was accused of **fronting for** an illegal network.”

「該公司被指控替非法網絡**作掩護／充當幌子**。」

Practice 55

> “The organization allegedly **fronted for** another group.”

「據稱該組織替另一個團體**作掩護**。」

front for something = 表面上代表一個正常組織, 但實際替另一項隱藏活動作掩護

29. **frontal = relating to the front (前面的／正面的) — 前部的; 正面的**

A useful derivative.

Practice 56

> “The car suffered severe **frontal damage**.”

「汽車的**前部**嚴重受損。」

Practice 57

> “The photograph shows a **frontal view** of the building.”

「照片展示大樓的**正面視角**。」

frontal = 與某人／某物前面部分有關的; 從正面而來的

30. **frontal attack (正面攻擊) — 正面進攻; 直接攻擊**

Literal and figurative.

Practice 58

> “The army launched a **frontal attack**.”

「軍隊發動了**正面進攻**。」

Practice 59

> “The article launched a **frontal attack** on the policy.”

「這篇文章對該政策作出了**直接而正面的猛烈批評**。」

frontal attack = 從正面直接攻擊; 比喻毫不迂迴地直接批評／挑戰

31. **frontage** = front side/length facing a street (臨街正面／frontage) — 正面；臨街面

A useful property/architecture term.

Practice 60

> “The shop has twenty metres of street **frontage**.”

「這間店有二十米的**臨街正面寬度**。」

Practice 61

> “Properties with sea **frontage** are expensive.”

「擁有**臨海正面／直接面向海岸地段**的物業很昂貴。」

frontage = 建築物或土地面向道路、河流、海岸等的正面部分／長度

32. **waterfront / seafont** (海濱／水邊地區) — 海濱；濱水區

These are common lexical extensions containing **front**.

Practice 62

> “We had dinner near the **waterfront**.”

「我們在**濱水區／海旁**附近吃晚飯。」

Practice 63

> “The hotel is on the **seafront**.”

「酒店位於**海濱**。」

These should be treated as useful lexical extensions, not additional meanings of bare **front** itself.

Important distinction: **in front of** vs **at the front of**

This is crucial.

in front of

= outside/before something, or facing someone

> “She stood **in front of the building**.”

「她站在大樓**前面**。」

at the front of

= within something but in its forward section

> “She sat **at the front of the room**.”

「她坐在房間**前方**。」

Compare:

> “A car is **in front of the bus**.”

= 車在巴士前面。

> “She is sitting **at the front of the bus**.”

= 她坐在巴士內部的前排。

Very different spatial relationships.

Important distinction: **front vs face**

front

often refers to:

* the forward side/part;

* position at the front.

face

can mean:

- * front surface;
- * especially the human face;
- * the side of something oriented in a direction;
- * confront something as a verb.

Compare:

> “the **front** of the building”

= 大樓的正面／前部

> “the building **faces** the river”

= 大樓面向河流

The words overlap in some spatial contexts but are not interchangeable everywhere.

Important distinction: **front** vs **façade**

front

is broad and neutral:

> “the front of the building”

façade

usually means:

1. the architectural front of a building;
2. figuratively, a false outward appearance.

> “a calm façade”

= 表面平靜的假象

Front can also have the figurative “false appearance” sense, but **façade** often sounds more literary/formal.

Important distinction: **front** vs **forefront**

front

can literally mean the forward part or position.

forefront

almost always means:

> the leading/most advanced position

> “at the forefront of research”

= 處於研究最前沿

You would not normally use **forefront** for:

> the front of a car.

Important distinction: **front = appearance vs front = illegal cover**

These are related but distinct.

Public appearance:

> “He put on a confident **front**.”

= 他表面裝作自信。

Cover organization:

> “The shop was a **front** for illegal activity.”

= 那家店是非法活動的幌子。

Both involve something shown outwardly, but the second specifically hides another operation/activity.

Important distinction: **front line vs forefront**

front line

focuses on:

- * direct contact with danger;
- * customers;
- * a crisis;
- * operational reality.

> front-line staff

= 第一線員工

forefront

focuses on:

- * leadership;
- * innovation;
- * advanced development.

> at the forefront of technology

= 科技最前沿

So:

front line = 第一線

forefront = 最前沿／領先位置

Important distinction: **front office vs front desk**

front desk

= physical reception counter/desk

> 酒店前台

front office

can mean:

- * reception/admin function;
- * management executives, especially in sport/business.

So the second is broader and more organizational.

Important distinction: **front = noun vs front = verb**

Noun:

> “the **front** of the building”

= 大樓前部

Verb:

> “The building **fronts** the park.”

= 大樓面向公園

Same spelling, different grammar and concept.

Important distinction: **frontal vs front**

front + noun

is ordinary and common:

> front door

> front seat

frontal

is more formal/technical and often used for:

- * frontal view
- * frontal damage
- * frontal attack

You would not normally say:

> ✗ frontal door

for an ordinary front door.

Family-extension sweep

The practical **front** family is rich in spatial, figurative, technical, and institutional uses:

- * **in front of** = 在……前面／面前
- * **the front** = 前部／正面
- * **front + noun** = 前面的／前部的
- * **at the front** = 在最前方
- * **front of the room** = 房間／課室前方
- * **front page** = 頭版
- * **front row** = 前排
- * **front desk** = 前台／接待處
- * **front office** = 前台部門／管理層
- * **front of house** = 對客服務前台
- * **front line** = 前線／第一線
- * **front-line** = 第一線的
- * **front — leading position** = 前列／領先位置
- * **forefront** = 最前沿／領先位置
- * **front — public image** = 對外姿態／表面形象
- * **put on a brave/confident front** = 表面裝作勇敢／自信
- * **front — cover** = 幌子／掩護
- * **on several fronts** = 在幾個方面／戰線
- * **war front** = 戰線
- * **weather front** = 氣象鋒面
- * **united front** = 統一陣線／一致立場
- * **front — false appearance** = 表面假象
- * **front + place — verb** = 面向
- * **front an organization/campaign** = 領導／代表
- * **front a band** = 擔任樂隊主唱／核心人物
- * **front a programme** = 主持節目
- * **front for** = 為……作掩護
- * **frontal** = 前部的／正面的
- * **frontal attack** = 正面攻擊
- * **frontage** = 臨街／臨水正面部分
- * **waterfront/seafront** = 濱水區／海濱

The main semantic branches are:

> **physical forward position**

> **outward-facing side**

> **leading/direct-contact position**

> **public outward appearance**

> **line/boundary of conflict or weather**

> **represent/lead as a verb**

Master comparison

Form / sense	MCQ-ready Traditional Chinese meaning
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in front of	處於某人／某物前方，通常面向對方或位於對方可直接看見的位置
the front — physical part	某物朝向前方或主要外側的一面／部分
front + noun	位於某物前方或前部位置的
at the front	處於某個空間、隊伍或群體最前方的位置
front of the room	房間中面向觀眾／學生的主要前方位置
front — visible side	面向外界、最容易被看見的主要外側表面
front page	報紙最前面、通常放置最重要新聞的版面
front desk	酒店、辦公室或機構入口附近負責接待訪客的櫃檯／部門
front office	負責對外接觸／接待，或在某些行業中指管理決策的部門
front of house	與顧客／觀眾直接接觸的服務區域或工作
front line	最接近戰鬥、危機、顧客或主要問題現場的位置；前線／第一線
front-line	直接面對顧客、病人、危機或主要工作現場的
front — leading position	在某個領域、行動或發展中處於前列／領先位置
forefront	在某個領域的發展、創新或行動中處於最領先的位置
front — public image	特意展示給別人看的外在態度／形象，可能跟真正感受不同
put on a brave/confident front	雖然內心未必如此，但對外表現出勇敢／自信
front — cover for hidden activity	表面正常，但實際用來掩飾另一項秘密或非法活動的組織／業務
on several fronts	在幾個不同方面、領域或問題上同時行動／面對壓力
front — military	戰爭中軍隊直接交戰的地區／戰線
weather front	不同性質氣團之間的交界面／氣象鋒面
united front	多方對外表現一致、團結的共同立場／陣線
front — false appearance	用來掩飾真實感受、目的或情況的表面形象
front + place — verb	建築物／地方的正面朝向某個方向或位置
front an organization/campaign	作為最公開、最主要的代表人物領導／代表某組織或活動
front a band	作為樂隊最主要代表表演者，通常擔任主唱

front a programme	作為節目的主要主持／出鏡代表人物	
front for something	表面代表正常活動, 實際替另一項隱藏活動作掩護	
frontal	與某物前面部分有關, 或從正面而來的	
frontal attack	從正面直接進攻; 比喻毫不迂迴地直接批評／挑戰	
frontage	建築物／土地面向道路、河流、海岸等的正面部分或長度	
waterfront/seafront	鄰近海、河等水域的濱水／海濱地區	

For your original passage

> “I had to speak ****in front of**** about two hundred colleagues and several senior managers.”

The exact meaning is:

****in front of = 處於那群人的前方並面向他們, 讓他們可以直接看見和聽見你****

Therefore:

> ****speak in front of two hundred colleagues****

= ****「在二百位同事面前發言／面向二百位同事演講」****

The phrase also helps explain why the situation felt stressful:

you were not simply ****near**** two hundred colleagues.

You were positioned:

> ****before them + facing them + as the focus of their attention****

So the most natural Traditional Chinese mapping is:

****in front of an audience = 在觀眾面前****

The most important learner contrasts are:

> ****in front of the audience****

> = 在觀眾面前

> ****at the front of the room****

> = 在房間前方

> ****the front of the building****

> = 大樓正面／前部

> **front row**

> = 前排

> **front desk**

> = 前台／接待處

> **front line**

> = 前線／第一線

> **a confident front**

> = 對外表現出的自信姿態

> **a front for illegal activity**

> = 非法活動的幌子

> **a cold front**

> = 冷鋒

> **front a campaign**

> = 領導／代表一項宣傳活動

So **front** is much richer than simply:

> **front = 前面**

In your passage specifically, the core meaning is the fixed spatial construction:

in front of + audience = 在觀眾面前, 面向觀眾發言.